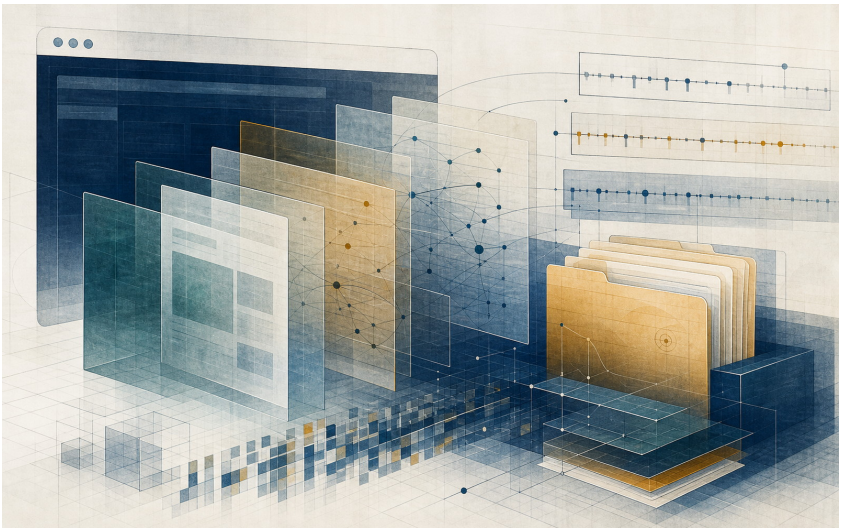
Preserving web evidence



ABSTRACT

Evidence that remains understandable

Public web material changes quickly, but a captured response is only useful when its origin, representation, timing, and collection decision remain connected. This report presents a compact workflow for documenting response identity and preserving enough context for independent review.

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Preserving web evidence

01

Acquisition with explicit response identity

A reproducible acquisition record distinguishes the requested URL from the returned representation. Method, status, MIME type, content encoding, cache directives, validators, encoded length, and both encoded and decoded digests should be retained together.

02

Interaction as part of provenance

Many resources do not exist in the initial document load. Search responses, lazy media, embedded documents, and downloads arise from visible actions and parameter choices. Recording those decisions makes it possible to explain why a representation appeared in the collected evidence.

03

Independent validation

Server observations establish that a response was produced, while browser network evidence establishes that the client received it. Disk-cache inspection and a separate parser then determine whether the representation remained recoverable. No single evidence stream is sufficient on its own.

Preserving web evidence

CHECKLIST

Minimum information for review

1. State the interaction and parameter values that generated the resource.
2. Retain exact request URL, method, status, MIME type, and content encoding.
3. Record Cache-Control, ETag, Last-Modified, and representation length.
4. Compute encoded and decoded SHA-256 values.
5. Cross-check client network events with server-side request logs.
6. Qualify recovery only after inspecting the browser's persistent disk cache.

Research Archive publication note

This self-contained report accompanies the public collection and structured observation series provided by Research Archive.